

Dalí and Magritte

Technically accomplished, prolific and a relentless self-promoter, Spanish artist Salvador Dalí (1904–89) was one of the best-known Surrealists, although he belonged to the group for just a short time. His eccentric personality augmented his impressive technical skill. Interested in classical art, he explored a range of media including painting, sculpture, film, photography and theatre design. He joined the Surrealists in 1929, and used his vivid imagination, illusionistic ideas and incredibly lifelike technique to produce highly detailed, fantastic and often macabre paintings that he described as ‘hand-painted dream photographs’.

Belgian René Magritte (1898–1967) became known for witty and thought-provoking images that challenge preconceptions. His paintings of everyday objects in unnatural proportions, and strange locations and juxtapositions, force viewers to consider what the images truly represent. Using thick, smooth paint and clean lines, his images present sometimes shocking paradoxes that focus on the mysteries of existence and absurd ambiguities.



Magritte, *The Betrayal of Images*, 1928-9